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A GREAT AMBASSADOR FOR TEST CRICKET WHEN THE FORMAT WAS LOSING OUT TO THE EXPLOSION OF T20 CRICKET. TRUE, T20 BRINGS IN THE MOOLAH, BUT VIRAT BROUGHT THE FANS TO THE TEST ARENAS, AT HOME AND OVERSEAS

clapping, and leading. When he ran between the wickets, he didn't just run; he sprinted the fastest for the second and third runs. And when he celebrated, it was volcanic: fist pumping, feet thumping, joy uncontained and contagious. He didn't just want to win; he wanted the world to feel it with him.

I don't like comparisons. I've been asked about Gavaskar and Tendulkar. I was lucky enough to share the dressing room with them. But I saw Virat from a different vantage — not just from the comfort of the broadcaster's box, but through

the suffocating pressure that only a dressing room can know. I saw him walk out not to play cricket, but to command it. To own the battlefield. In doing so, he didn't just win games; he rewired how India played cricket.

It was exciting as a coach to plot those Test victories. His batting form

was paramount to the cause, but it was not just about coaching, making runs or taking wickets. Credit should be given to the magnificent work by the support staff, which made India the best fielding side in the world. It was collective, but Virat's positivity was critical to India's success. It was